

Cat & Company

*24 pp*

**Issue 4**

# ***No More Nothing***

David White

## Page 1

### Panel 1 (*Half page width, 1/3rd page height*):

**Camillo Skragg** sits in the driver's seat of the **2018 Ford Focus** they've been loaned by the State of Oklahoma. **Penny Skragg** sits in the passenger seat, holding an M4A1 carbine. She's double-checking everything, trying to make sure it will work. The **2018 Ford Focus** is inside the "Civic Centre Parkade" (sic) at 550 W 3rd St.

#### **Penny Skragg**

I pressed the *forward assist*, and it's like nothing happened.

#### **Camillo Skragg**

I think it's *supposed* to do that.

You ready?

### Panel 2 (*Half page width, 1/3rd page height*):

**Penny Skragg** carefully points the carbine out of the car and tries to relax in the passenger seat.

#### **Penny Skragg**

Ask me once it's over.

### Panel 3 (*Half page width, 1/3rd page height*):

**Camillo Skragg** grabs the steering wheel and pulls himself up into a ready position.

#### **Camillo Skragg**

Yeah, no *shit*.

### Panel 4 (*Half page width, 1/3rd page height*):

A message is received on a smartphone in a stand on the dashboard. **Camillo Skragg** reads it and clears the notification.

#### **Camillo Skragg**

The *arraignment* is over.

### Panel 5 (*Half page width, 1/3rd page height*):

**Camillo Skragg** starts the engine of the **2018 Ford Focus**.

### Panel 6 (*Half page width, 1/3rd page height*):

**Camillo Skragg** puts the **2018 Ford Focus** in "drive".

#### **Camillo Skragg**

They'll be out shortly.

Here we go.

## Page 2

### Panel 1 (*Half page width, 1/3rd page height*):

The **2018 Ford Focus** rolls down the spiral driveway with **Camillo Skragg** behind the wheel and **Penny Skragg** in the passenger seat.

#### Box (*FEMA Liaison, not visible*)

"Downtown's been evacuated of *non-essential personnel*."

#### Box (*Mayor of Tulsa, not visible*)

"We've loaned them a *surplus car* from the *Municipal fleet*."

### Panel 2 (*Half page width, 1/3rd page height*):

The engine of the **2018 Ford Focus** idles as **Penny Skragg** moves to sit on the passenger-side door, holding the carbine; she will be firing over the roof of the car.

#### Box (*General of the Oklahoma National Guard, not visible*)

"Against my *better judgment*, we provided the Skraggs a *carbine* and some *ammunition*."

"Evidently they want their *pound of flesh*."

### Panel 3 (*Full page width, 1/3rd page height*):

From left to right, **The Eye**, **Thresher**, and **Jolt** stand in front of the "Page Belcher Federal Building" entrance at 333 W 4th St.

#### The Eye

They're— *letting us go*?

#### Thresher

Not exactly. We need to stick around for our *next court date*.

#### Jolt

I think "*Not Guilty*" was the right *plea*.

Victor was the one who *did the deed*.

### Panel 4 (*Full page width, 1/3rd page height*):

A view down W 4th St. The **2018 Ford Focus** speeds down the empty road, and **Penny Skragg** aims over the roof of the car. **The Eye** points vaguely in the direction of the oncoming car.

#### The Eye

Hey!

We're in *dan*—

## Page 3

### Panel 1 (*Full page width, 1/3rd page height*):

**The Eye** is struck in the head by a bullet, dying instantly. **Jolt** and **Thresher** begin to react. Several other bullets strike the pavement, and one lodges in **Thresher's** armored body.

### **The Eye** (*dying*)

ghhhh–

### Title

No More Nothing

### Panel 2 (*Full page width, 1/3rd page height*):

**Penny Skragg** fires the carbine over the roof of the speeding **2018 Ford Focus**, while **Camillo Skragg** floors the accelerator.

### Panel 3 (*Half page width, 1/3rd page height*):

**Jolt** and **Thresher** run after the **2018 Ford Focus**, and prepare to take to the air.

### Panel 4 (*Half page width, 1/3rd page height*):

**Jolt** and **Thresher** fly after the **2018 Ford Focus** over W 4th St. **Penny Skragg** is back in the passenger seat and flips the safety on the carbine. **Camillo Skragg** is looking a little nervous.

## Page 4

### Panel 1 (*Half page width, 1/3rd page height*):

**Jinx Bubastis** teleports onto **Thresher's** back with a shower of sparks. She holds on to his shoulders and stands on his back.

SF/X

VASSSP!

### Panel 2 (*Half page width, 1/3rd page height*):

**Peter Cat** flies through the asphalt surface of W 4th St with a streak of smoke, and takes position behind **Jolt**. **Jolt** fires a lightning bolt from her right arm emitter at the **2018 Ford Focus** but misses. She is preparing to take another shot with the emitter on her left arm.

### Panel 3 (*Half page width, 1/3rd page height*):

**Jinx Bubastis** snaps **Thresher's** neck. His mask flies off.

### Panel 4 (*Half page width, 1/3rd page height*):

**Peter Cat** channels a hellish blast of plasma into a tight shell around **Jolt**. Her body burns to ash in milliseconds.

### Panel 5 (*Half page width, 1/3rd page height*):

**Jinx Bubastis** rides **Thresher's** corpse down to the pavement, and somersaults off his back as he skids to a stop on the street.

### Panel 6 (*Half page width, 1/3rd page height*):

Air resistance catches up to **Jolt**. Her body collapses into a cloud of ash. **Peter Cat** touches down near **Jinx Bubastis'** position.

## Page 5

### Panel 1 (*Half page width, 1/3rd page height*):

**Peter Cat** looks over at **Jinx Bubastis**. They are both realizing that it's over, for now.

**Peter Cat**

Target down.

**Jinx Bubastis**

Mine, too.

### Panel 2 (*Half page width, 1/3rd page height*):

The **2018 Ford Focus** has made a U-Turn on the empty W 4th St, and has stopped near **Peter Cat** and **Jinx Bubastis**. **Camillo Skragg** and **Penny Skragg** get out of the car. **Peter Cat** looks over at the humans.

**Camillo Skragg (to Penny Skragg)**

Are *you* shaking?

I'm shaking.

**Penny Skragg**

That means *we're not dead*.

**Peter Cat**

Let's get the *corpses* together.

### Panel 3 (*Half page width, 1/3rd page height*):

A close view of **Peter Cat**, who has a disturbingly neutral facial expression.

**Peter Cat**

I have enough *regard* for my *former colleagues* to not want to see them on a *dissection table*.

We'll *burn* the *bodies*.

### Panel 4 (*Half page width, 1/3rd page height*):

**Penny Skragg** looks horrified.

**Penny Skragg**

Dude...

I don't know *how to feel about that*.

### Panel 5 (*Half page width, 1/3rd page height*):

**Penny Skragg** gestures towards the front of the courthouse.

**Penny Skragg**

Also, I kinda *domed* the Eye.

I think there're *bits of her head* all over the place.

### Panel 6 (*Half page width, 1/3rd page height*):

A close view of **Peter Cat**. He looks focussed, concentrating on the moment, getting an unpleasant job done.

**Peter Cat**

I'll have to do clean-up anyway.

Broken glass, bullets, cartridge casings.

Let's get to *work*.

## Page 6

### Panel 1 (*Half page width, 1/3rd page height*):

The **Crisis Center**; we finally see the people who were talking into boxes in the last few pages. **Jake Lyon** sits next to **The Magister** at the conference table.

**Jake Lyon**

Let's *pretend* I'm OK with the *Vlad Tepes* logic of putting *Honor Guard's* heads on stakes...  
...how are we going to explain it to *the American people*?

**The Magister**

Poochie.

**Jake Lyon**

What!?

### Panel 2 (*Half page width, 1/3rd page height*):

**Jake Lyon** looks at **The Magister** with obvious disbelief. **The Magister** keeps talking.

**The Magister\***

"They died on the way back to their home planet."

**Jake Lyon**

"The Simpsons"? *Really?*

**The Magister\***

Look at it from a *historic perspective*.

The *primary sources* are limited. All we need to do add enough *deliberate inconsistencies* to keep the *scholars* and *prodromal schizophrenics* busy.

You act like *truth matters*.

### Panel 3 (*Half page width, 1/3rd page height*):

**Jake Lyon** looks at **The Magister** with open astonishment. **The Magister** looks at the doorway and smiles at what he sees.

**Jake Lyon**

It *doesn't*?

**The Magister\***

You're *very clever*, you must have *noticed* by now.

I see the *hunters* have returned.

### Panel 4 (*Half page width, 1/3rd page height*):

**Peter Cat**, **Jinx Bubastis**, **Camillo Skragg**, and **Penny Skragg** enter the **Crisis Center**. They look a little tired.

**Peter Cat**

We stopped by the *police morgue* before coming here.

Jinx can tell you more.

**Jinx Bubastis**

The police guarding *Honor Guard's* shuttle were killed by a particularly *invasive* mind probe.

That's more *Demonlayer* than *Victor Bravo*.

### Panel 5 (*Half page width, 1/3rd page height*):

**Jake Lyon** seems relieved to talk about relatively real things.

**Jake Lyon**

RVS Tulsa ATC said they lost track of the shuttle after a couple of sweeps.

Is it *stealth*?

**Panel 6 (*Half page width, 1/3rd page height*):**

**Jinx Bubastis** looks thoughtful.

**Jinx Bubastis**

If it's using *shields*, it's the *opposite* of stealth.

This is another piece of evidence that *Demonlayer* has taken the shuttle.

I think we can *eliminate* a possible *orbital* flight.

We need to *investigate the landing site*.



## Page 7

### Panel 1 (*Half page width, 1/3rd page height*):

The bottom of the **Corporate escape pod**. **Victor Bravo** has survived a transcontinental flight on the outside of the pod, and is still clinging to the shuttle – barely.

#### Box (**Jake Lyon, not visible**)

What about *Victor Bravo*?

He's still *out there*, right?

### Panel 1a (*small square inset*):

**Victor Bravo's** hand slips – he has lost his grip.

### Panel 2 (*Half page width, 1/3rd page height*):

**Victor Bravo** falls. He's not unconscious, but he's not able to react right now.

#### Box (**Jinx Bubastis, not visible**)

If we are *very lucky* Demonslayer *killed* him.

I doubt it, though. She'd have made a *spectacle* of it.

### Panel 3 (*Half page width, 1/3rd page height*):

**Victor Bravo** lands in a lake. It's Center Lake, in the Whittier Narrows Recreation area. The impact should be lethal, and probably would be if he weren't an alien super-soldier.

#### Box (**Peter Cat, not visible**)

*Jinx* is right.

### Panel 4 (*Half page width, 1/3rd page height*):

Unfortunately, the fall and impact were not lethal. **Victor Bravo** crawls onto the shore.

#### Box (**Peter Cat, not visible**)

*Victor Bravo* is still a *threat*.

### Panel 5 (*Full page width, 1/3rd page height*):

The **Corporate escape pod** keeps flying over Montebello, and approaches downtown Los Angeles.

#### Killotron (*from inside pod*)

A landscape gnarled with alien breath,

We're cloaked in silence, veiled from their gaze.

Mistress' hand weaves the void's dark thread–

The primitives' radio beams – blind to our threat.

#### Demonslayer (*from inside pod*)

"*Alien breath?*"

Really, Killotron?

This *obscene sprawl* looks like a *tumor* to me.

## Page 8

### Panel 1 (Full page width, 1/3rd page height):

Near sundown, a view from slightly above the parking lot of the Tulsa Expo Center, where the **Corporate escape pod** landed. It's been marked off with crime scene tape. **Jinx Bubastis** approaches the middle of the side. **Peter Cat**, **Camillo Skragg**, and **Penny Skragg** follow close behind.

#### Box (narration, upper left)

A little later, at the *landing site*...

#### Jinx Bubastis

The problem with *psychometry* is that the *impressions* become *unstuck in time*.  
Of course *Victor Bravo* was here.  
He flew the shuttle when it landed.  
I couldn't tell you if he *came back*, it all *blends together*.

### Panel 2 (1/3rd page width, 1/3rd page height):

**Jinx Bubastis** kneels and closes her eyes, gesturing with one hand to feel the impressions.

#### Jinx Bubastis

I can feel *Bearcat*...  
...and I can feel *Bearcat seeing Killotron*...  
...where is *she*?

### Panel 3 (1/3rd page width, 1/3rd page height):

**Jinx Bubastis** reacts as if she got an electric shock.

#### Jinx Bubastis (shouting in pain)

AH--!!

#### Peter Cat (off-panel)

Jinx!?

### Panel 4 (1/3rd page width, 1/3rd page height):

**Jinx Bubastis** pulls back her hand. **Peter Cat** stands behind her, concerned.

#### Jinx Bubastis

A *ward*.  
A *hex* on this place.

### Panel 5 (Half page width, 1/3rd page height):

**Jinx Bubastis** looks concerned. **Peter Cat** turns to think a little.

#### Jinx Bubastis

Now I *know* she was here--  
--but *she* knows we're on this planet!

### Panel 6 (Half page width, 1/3rd page height):

**Peter Cat** approaches **Jinx Bubastis** and smiles a little.

#### Peter Cat

Excellent.  
That means she knows we have the *only way off this rock*.  
That means *leverage*.

## Page 9

### Panel 1 (*Half page width, 1/3rd page height*):

Nighttime on Radio Hill in Elysium Park, a location near Downtown Los Angeles. The area is largely inhabited by the homeless. **Bearcat** and **Killotron** have been sent to clear an encampment near where **Demonlayer** has set up her base; she is planning on using the antenna here in the near future. A close-up of a woman's face, illuminated by a nearby fire. The last few years of her life has not been kind to her. Half of her face is splattered with blood. She wants to scream, but cannot.

#### Box (*narration, upper left*)

Near Downtown L.A. is an abandoned place called *Radio Hill*.

#### Bearcat (*off-panel*)

The *female*!

There!

#### Box (*narration, lower right*)

The *desperate* use it as a *place of refuge*.

### Panel 2 (*Half page width, 1/3rd page height*):

**Killotron** has one of his arm-mounted laser cannon extended, and fires at a target off-panel. **Bearcat** takes a child-like joy at **Killotron's** destruction of the target. The camp has been wrecked; tents burn.

#### SF/X (*near Killotron's laser cannon*)

FWEEEE!

#### SF/X (*off-panel, from the target of Killotron's laser cannon*)

SPLORT!!

#### Bearcat

Hah!

Well *done*, Killotron!

The area is secured!

### Panel 3 (*Half page width, 1/3rd page height*):

**Bearcat** looks thoughtful as he speaks to **Killotron**. **Killotron** listens closely.

#### Bearcat

It is *fortunate* that Mistress has found a way home.

It is *unfortunate* that this makes me ask a *disturbing question*.

### Panel 4 (*Half page width, 1/3rd page height*):

**Bearcat** continues talking to **Killotron**.

#### Bearcat

Was she prepared to *sacrifice us both*?

### Panel 5 (*Full page width, 1/3rd page height*):

**Bearcat** and **Killotron** turn to look at the lights of Downtown Los Angeles, illuminated from behind by small fires. **Bearcat** ponders.

#### Killotron

My beam carved art from ash and bone,

A symphony of smoke and flame.

Comrade's eyes, once wild, now gleam—

A mind forged in her silent name.

You whisper doubt, a blade unsharpened:

"Does she carve our fate into the void?"

Yet in her gaze, a star's slow burn—

A reckoning born where shadows roil.

**Bearcat**

It is *good* to see her *functioning* again.  
I believe this is going to work.

## Page 10

### Panel 1 (Half page width. 1/3rd page height):

Inside the **Crisis Center**, **Jinx Bubastis** hands out small devices – **neurocomms** – to **Peter Cat**, **Camillo Skragg**, and **Penny Skragg**. **Peter Cat** puts his behind his ear. **Camillo Skragg** looks at his with some curiosity. **Penny Skragg** also puts hers behind her right ear.

**Jinx Bubastis (to Camillo Skragg)**

Here, take this.

**Camillo Skragg**

What is it?

**Jinx Bubastis (to Camillo Skragg)**

It's a *neurocomm* – a *neural interface* attached to a tiny *interocitor*.

There's software that lets you *stream* sensory inputs, too.

### Panel 2 (Half page width. 1/3rd page height):

**Penny Skragg** looks at **Camillo Skragg**. **Camillo Skragg** looks through a semi-transparent image of what **Penny Skragg** sees. **Jinx Bubastis** looks at this with mild amusement.

**Camillo Skragg**

Whoa.

**Penny Skragg**

See? This is what *I* see.

**Camillo Skragg**

Neat!

**Jinx Bubastis**

Since we're doing *counter-insurgency* now, we're going to need good coordination and mobility.

These should help a lot, especially if we have to split up.

### Panel 3 (Half page width. 1/3rd page height):

The **DHS Liaison** is talking on her smartphone. She gestures towards **Peter Cat**, **Jinx Bubastis**, **Camillo Skragg**, and **Penny Skragg**, getting their attention.

**DHS Liaison (into smartphone)**

So, it's a *confirmed* sighting?

Let me put you on *speakerphone*.

### Panel 4 (Half page width. 1/3rd page height):

The **DHS Liaison** puts her smartphone on the conference table. **Jinx Bubastis'** eyes glow as she telepathically makes contact with the caller.

**Smartphone (Dispatch officer)**

Hello! This is the East LA Sheriff's Department. As I was saying, we have reports of a *seven-foot cat-man* in Whittier and Montebello. eep!

**Jinx Bubastis (word of power)**

Pardon me, I need to *see through your eyes*.

We'll be right there.

### Panel 5 (Half page width. 1/3rd page height):

An office in the **East LA Sheriff's Department**. **Peter Cat**, **Jinx Bubastis**, **Camillo Skragg**, and **Penny Skragg** appear in a shower of sparks. The **Dispatch officer** is shocked by their sudden appearance; she is looking directly at the space where they appear.

**Dispatch officer**

Yikes!

**Jinx Bubastis**

So, you were *saying*?

**Panel 6 (*Half page width. 1/3rd page height*):**

**Jinx Bubastis** talks to the **Dispatch officer**. In the background, a **Radio operator** tries to get their attention.

**Dispatch officer**

Right... Our best guess is that he'll be heading to *Whittier Boulevard*.

**Radio operator**

Hey! *KJC625* just went down.

That's the LAPD's station.

## Page 11

### Panel 1 (*Half page width. 1/3rd page height*):

**Demonlayer** appears on every screen; her voice emerges from every speaker.

#### **Demonlayer (TV)**

Ape creatures! Please attend carefully.

You are in *mortal danger*.

I have hidden *several powerful bombs* in different locations.

### Panel 2 (*Half page width. 1/3rd page height*):

**Jinx Bubastis** makes a “shoo” gesture to **Peter Cat**. **Peter Cat** leaves behind a smoky streak as he flies through the ceiling. **Demonlayer** continues her address.

#### **Demonlayer (TV)**

If *one* is tampered with, *all* will explode.

If *any* attempt to approach my position on *Radio Hill* is made, *all* will explode.

*Any* attempt to intervene, and I will *immediately* trigger detonation.

#### **Jinx Bubastis (to Peter Cat)**

*Get out* before she *detects* you!

#### **Peter Cat (speech balloon trailing flight path)**

On it!

### Panel 3 (*Half page width. 1/3rd page height*):

**Demonlayer** keeps talking.

#### **Demonlayer (TV)**

*Others* of our kind are on your world!

*One* has a *starship*.

*She* will bring that ship to *Radio Hill*.

#### **Radio operator**

How is she *transmitting*—?

#### **Jinx Bubastis (to Radio operator)**

Sympathetic magic.

### Panel 4 (*Half page width. 1/3rd page height*):

**Demonlayer** ends her speech.

#### **Demonlayer (TV)**

One way or another, the bombs *will* explode.

Your *city* is forfeit.

You may *panic* now.

### Panel 5 (*Half page width. 1/3rd page height*):

**Camillo Skragg** turns around suddenly. The **Radio operator** talks to him, pointing at the exit.

#### **Camillo Skragg**

Wait a minute...

...where's *Penny*?

#### **Radio operator**

I think she went down to the *motor pool*.

**Panel 6** (*Half page width. 1/3rd page height*):

**Penny Skragg** speeds out of the motor pool on a police motorcycle. **Camillo Skragg** calls after her from an open window.

**SF/X** (*Penny Skragg's motorcycle*)

VROOM!

**Camillo Skragg**

Penny! *Wait!*



## Page 12

### Panel 1 (*Half page width. 1/3rd page height*):

**Penny Skragg** takes a broad right turn onto Whittier Blvd on her “borrowed” police motorcycle.

### Panel 2 (*Half page width. 1/3rd page height*):

**Penny Skragg** stands on the saddle of the motorcycle as she bears down on a running **Victor Bravo**.

### Panel 2a (*small square inset*)

**Penny Skragg** firmly grabs the left, front brake of the motorcycle, causing the front wheel to jam.

### Panel 3 (*Full page width, 1/3rd page height*):

**Penny Skragg** is launched into a high arc over **Victor Bravo** and turns as she somersaults; she will land facing him once he gets up. The police motorcycle also somersaults, in a lower arc that catches **Victor Bravo** in the back and slams him into the pavement.

### Panel 4 (*Half page width. 1/3rd page height*):

**Victor Bravo** recovers quickly and gets to his feet, seemingly uninjured. **Penny Skragg** lands in a ready stance.

### Panel 5 (*Half page width. 1/3rd page height*):

**Victor Bravo** lowers into a crouch to charge at **Penny Skragg**. **Penny Skragg** make a “bring it” gesture with one hand.

### **Victor Bravo**

Is this some kind of joke?

## Page 13

*Note: All continuity issues are intentional. Penny's a reality warper, bullshit is her weapon. It should look at least superficially plausible.*

### **Panel 1 (Full page width, 1/3rd page height):**

**Victor Bravo** lunges forwards, a comically large plastic (but very, very sharp) combat knife in his right hand. He is attempting to decapitate **Penny Skragg** with a single swing. **Penny Skragg** ducks down deep and performs a Bruce Lee-style leg sweep.

### **Panel 2 (1/3rd page width, 1/3rd page height):**

**Penny Skragg's** right arm hooks around **Victor Bravo's** extended right arm, like she performed an improbably quick roll after knocking **Victor Bravo's** foot out from under him.

### **Panel 3 (1/3rd page width, 1/3rd page height):**

**Penny Skragg** crouches, with the knife in her hand. In the background, **Victor Bravo** recovers very quickly, getting his feet back under him in a crouched stance, with his back to **Penny Skragg**.

### **Panel 4 (1/3rd page width, 1/3rd page height):**

**Penny Skragg** slams the knife hilt-deep into **Victor Bravo's** grotesquely muscled left thigh.

### **Victor Bravo (shout of pain)**

GRAGH!

### **Panel 5 (Half page width. 1/3rd page height):**

**Victor Bravo** looks down at the knife hilt embedded into the outside of his left thigh. In the background, **Penny Skragg** sprints towards the locked gate covering the front door of a vacant building.

### **Panel 6 (Half page width. 1/3rd page height):**

**Victor Bravo** returns the bloody blade into the scabbard on his right boot. His gaze is fixated on the still-closed gate, which rattles a little after **Penny Skragg** somehow entered the vacant building.

## Page 14

*Note: All continuity issues are intentional. Penny's a reality warper, bullshit is her weapon. It should look at least superficially plausible.*

### **Panel 1 (Half page width. 1/3rd page height):**

**Victor Bravo** smashes through the front door of the vacant building, breaking the gate and door frame into pieces, tearing out bits of wall.

### **Panel 2 (Half page width. 1/3rd page height):**

Light streams into the darkened interior of the vacant building through the open back door. **Victor Bravo** charges forward towards it.

### **Panel 3 (1/3rd page width. 1/3rd page height):**

**Victor Bravo** face-plants just outside the back door. Behind him is a crude set of stairs made of cinder blocks.

### **Panel 4 (1/3rd page width. 1/3rd page height):**

**Victor Bravo** looks back at the staircase; it should be six blocks in a 3-2-1 configuration, but the bottom step is missing.

### **Panel 5 (1/3rd page width. 1/3rd page height):**

The missing cinder block impacts the top of **Victor Bravo's** head, shattering.

### **Panel 6 (Half page width. 1/3rd page height):**

**Victor Bravo** flies up to the roof using his jetpack.

### **Panel 7 (Half page width. 1/3rd page height):**

**Victor Bravo** has landed on the roof. He reaches for his side-arm, and looks down to confirm that it's missing from its holster.

## Page 15

*Note: All continuity issues are intentional. Penny's a reality warper, bullshit is her weapon. It should look at least superficially plausible.*

### Panel 1 (Half page width. 1/3rd page height):

**Penny Skragg** lifts **Victor Bravo's** oversized sidearm to aim it at **Victor Bravo's** solar plexus. **Victor Bravo** stands there, slack-jawed.

### Panel 2 (Half page width. 1/3rd page height):

A laser blast strikes **Victor Bravo's** body armor; there is a small explosion of sparks.

SF/X ZZAP

**Victor Bravo (grunt of pain)** gnnh...

### Panel 3 (Half page width. 1/3rd page height):

Much like Panel 2. **Penny Skragg** has found the second trigger, and has fired a miniature explosive shell into **Victor Bravo's** solar plexus. There is a muffled explosion.

SF/X (muffled explosion) THOMP

### Panel 4 (Half page width. 1/3rd page height):

**Victor Bravo** falls to his knees. He has been disemboweled inside his body armor. Blood is already starting to pool around his knees.

**Victor Bravo (dying)**

It's... cold...

### Panel 5 (Full page width. 1/3rd page height):

**Penny Skragg** looks on in horror as **Victor Bravo** falls face-first onto the roof of the vacant building. **Victor Bravo** bleeds out.

**Victor Bravo (dying)**

Whyzit...

...col-

**Box (lower right, Penny Skragg, neurocomm)**

"Victor Bravo's down."

## Page 16

### Panel 1 (*Full page width, 1/3rd page height*):

A large monitor inside the **Crisis Center** shows news footage from a helicopter of the roof in East LA where **Victor Bravo** died. **Penny Skragg** is curled up into a ball and is barely visible. **Victor Bravo's** corpse lies prone in a large pool of blood. The **Mayor of Tulsa** stares at the monitor; he is feeling both triumph and horror. **Jake Lyon** is cradling his head. **The Magister** is sitting next to him, watching events unfold with a slight smile. Several other figures are clapping in the foreground.

#### **Mayor of Tulsa** (*under his breath*)

Got the fucker...

#### **Jake Lyon** (*exhausted*)

It's not over yet.

### Panel 2 (*Half page width, 1/3rd page height*):

**Jake Lyon** turns to **The Magister**.

#### **The Magister**

No, it isn't.

But it's only a matter of time.

#### **Jake Lyon**

You're confident.

### Panel 3 (*Half page width, 1/3rd page height*):

**Jake Lyon** tries to stare down **The Magister**, who does not respond.

#### **Jake Lyon**

I know *journalists*.

I can tell them the *truth*.

*Then* what would you do?

### Panel 4 (*Half page width, 1/3rd page height*):

**The Magister** gets up from the table and smiles at **Jake Lyon**.

#### **The Magister**

I hope you weren't expecting some kind of *theatrical threat*.

### Panel 5 (*Half page width, 1/3rd page height*):

**The Magister's** back as he heads for the door to the **Crisis Center**.

#### **The Magister**

We all do what we must.

## Page 17

### Panel 1 (Full page width, 1/3rd page height)

Mid-morning. **Peter Cat** hovers above LA at the edge of space.

#### **Peter Cat (neurocomm)**

I seem to be far enough away that *Demonlayer* can't sense me.  
But I'm *close enough* that I *could* neutralize the *bombs*.

### Panel 2 (Half page width, 1/3rd page height)

**Camillo Skragg** holds **Penny Skragg** in the **East LA Sheriff's Department**.

#### **Camillo Skragg (neurocomm)**

Penny's back.  
She seems to be OK.

### Panel 3 (Half page width, 1/3rd page height)

The **Radio operator** talks to **Jinx Bubastis**, and offers her an inexpensive aircraft radio.

#### **Radio operator**

The *airspace* over LA is *restricted* – you'll need to talk to ATC.

#### **Jinx Bubastis**

Gotcha. Do you have a summary of the procedures?

#### **Radio operator**

Yeah, over here.

### Panel 4 (Half page width, 1/3rd page height)

**Peter Cat** hovers above LA at the edge of space.

#### **Peter Cat (neurocomm)**

I haven't been able to locate the *bombs* yet.  
The *signal* is weak, and there's a *lot* of noise.

### Panel 5 (Half page width, 1/3rd page height)

**Camillo Skragg** thinks for a moment, and has an idea.

#### **Camillo Skragg (neurocomm)**

Wait a minute. The bombs use *antimatter*, right?  
Even a *tiny leak* would produce *gamma radiation*!

## Page 18

### Panel 1 (*Half page width, 1/3rd page height*)

**Camillo Skragg** talks on his smartphone.

**Camillo Skragg**

Hello? Professor?

Yes, it's me, Camillo.

### Panel 2 (*Half page width, 1/3rd page height*)

**Camillo Skragg** sits down and keeps talking.

**Camillo Skragg**

I'd need a big favor from you – could you have the Fermi Gamma-ray Space Telescope image the LA Basin?

You can do it now?

Great!

### Panel 3 (*Half page width, 1/3rd page height*)

**Camillo Skragg** seems palpably relieved. He hangs up.

**Camillo Skragg**

Thanks, you're a real life-saver.

### Panel 4 (*Half page width, 1/3rd page height*)

**Camillo Skragg** downloads the image onto his smartphone.

**Camillo Skragg** (*neurocomm*)

Peter?

Are you seeing this?

### Panel 5 (*Full page width, 1/3rd page height*)

**Peter Cat** looks through a translucent neurocomm projection of the image from the Fermi gamma-ray telescope.

**Peter Cat** (*neurocomm*)

Excellent.

Yes, this helps.

I can locate the bombs.

## Page 19

### Panel 1 (*Half page width. 1/3rd page height*):

The cockpit of the **Black Sabbath**. **Jinx Bubastis** operates an inexpensive aircraft radio (similar to a Garmin 115) that has been duct-taped to one of the consoles.

#### **Jinx Bubastis**

LAX Tower, Black Sabbath Niner Niner X-Ray, at two thousand seven hundred, request clearance en route to Radio Hill.

#### **LAX ATC (*from radio*)**

Black Sabbath Niner Niner X-Ray, maintain two thousand seven hundred,

#### **Jinx Bubastis**

Maintain two thousand seven hundred, wilco. Black Sabbath Niner Niner X-Ray.

### Panel 2 (*Half page width. 1/3rd page height*):

**Peter Cat** hangs on the edge of space above the Los Angeles Basin. He is concentrating intensely.

#### **Peter Cat (*neurocomm*)**

Good.

I have all ten bombs.

Isolating.

### Panel 3 (*Half page width. 1/3rd page height*):

**Jinx Bubastis** turns to the miniature gunnery station next to the cockpit. A view of the Radio Hill transmitter is on the screen. She has moved a targeting reticle to the building using a small joystick.

#### **Peter Cat (*neurocomm*)**

Isolated.

### Panel 4 (*Half page width. 1/3rd page height*):

**Jinx Bubastis** looks at the covered arming switch for the **Black Sabbath's** nose-mounted deck gun. It remains unarmed.

### Panel 5 (*Full page width. 1/3rd page height*):

The **Black Sabbath** lands near the entrance to the transmitter building. **Bearcat** and **Killotron** are standing watch outside the front door.



## Page 20

### Panel 1 (*Half page width. 1/3rd page height*):

**Bearcat** opens the door to let **Jinx Bubastis** in. **Killotron** has a laser cannon extended, and is closely following **Jinx Bubastis'** movements.

### Panel 2 (*Half page width. 1/3rd page height*):

**Demonlayer** turns to face **Jinx Bubastis**. She is holding a **detonator**.

#### **Demonlayer**

So, you came.

You know, I could use a new *Number Six*—

#### **Jinx Bubastis** (*interrupting Demonlayer*)

No.

### Panel 3 (*Half page width. 1/3rd page height*):

**Demonlayer** turns around to face **Jinx Bubastis**, with the **floating sphere** behind her.

#### **Demonlayer**

You brought your vessel?

#### **Jinx Bubastis**

Yes.

Come and *take* it.

### Panel 4 (*Half page width. 1/3rd page height*):

**Demonlayer** gives **Jinx Bubastis** a hard look. **Jinx Bubastis** does not react.

### Panel 5 (*Full page width. 1/3rd page height*):

**Demonlayer** waves one hand and gives an order. **Bearcat** and **Killotron** close in on **Jinx Bubastis**.

#### **Demonlayer**

Kill her.

## Page 21

### Panel 1 (*Half page width. 1/3rd page height*):

**Jinx Bubastis** has telepathically reached deep into **Bearcat's** mind; her words are **Words of Power**.

#### **Jinx Bubastis** (*Words of Power*)

Your mind was *never your own*.  
You were *always a pet*.  
Your *life* was a *lie*.

### Panel 2 (*Half page width. 1/3rd page height*):

**Bearcat** reels, his face distorted with despair. **Jinx Bubastis** jumps forwards and removes **Killotron's** head with an uppercut.

### Panel 3 (*Full page width. 1/3rd page height*):

**Killotron** staggers back, trying to aim his laser cannon blind. **Bearcat** puts a pistol to his own head.

#### **Killotron**

No light through shattered lenses—  
Yet my circuits hum with unyielding fire.  
Your fist a storm, your breath a blade,  
I'll carve your name in static—

### Panel 4 (*Half page width. 1/3rd page height*):

**Jinx Bubastis** shatters the crystal on **Killotron's** chest.

SF/X (*from behind Jinx Bubastis, Bearcat shoots himself in the head off-panel*)

BLAM!

### Panel 5 (*Half page width. 1/3rd page height*):

A ghostly wisp escapes from **Killotron's** inert body. **Jinx Bubastis** speaks **Words of Power** with a sad look.

#### **Jinx Bubastis** (*Words of Power*)

Be free now.

## Page 22

### Panel 1 (*Half page width. 1/3rd page height*):

**Jinx Bubastis** snatches the **detonator** from **Demonslayer**'s hand. **Demonslayer** is having difficulty processing what is happening.

#### **Jinx Bubastis**

No speech.

No wizards' duel.

### Panel 2 (*Half page width. 1/3rd page height*):

**Jinx Bubastis** depresses the plunger of the **detonator** while flipping off **Demonslayer**. **Demonslayer** is illuminated from behind by a light like a flashbulb, and not the detonation she was expecting.

#### **Jinx Bubastis**

No *suicide bomb*.

### Panel 3 (*Half page width. 1/3rd page height*):

**Jinx Bubastis** holds **Demonslayer** by the neck. She seems to be consuming a glowing smoky mass coming from **Demonslayer**'s head. **Jinx Bubastis** eats **Demonslayer**'s soul.

### Panel 4 (*Half page width. 1/3rd page height*):

Another realm. At the shores of the **Lake of Fire**, **Demonslayer** screams as **Jinx Bubastis** pins her arms behind her back and prepares to give her a shove.

### Panel 5 (*Full page width. 1/3rd page height*):

A view of the **Lake of Fire**. **Jinx Bubastis** has just pushed **Demonslayer** over the edge. You can get a good reference for how this should look from a Jack Chick tract.

## Page 23

### Panel 1 (*Half page width. 1/3rd page height*):

Early afternoon. **Peter Cat** touches down next to the landed **Black Sabbath**.

#### Box (*narration, upper left*)

Later...

#### Peter Cat

Jinx?

Are you OK?

### Panel 2 (*Half page width. 1/3rd page height*):

**Peter Cat** walks into the building, and is startled at the sight of **Bearcat's** body on the floor. In the foreground, **Jinx Bubastis** sits in the Hunters' Repose position and tries to clear her mind.

#### Peter Cat

Penny's with Camillo, and doing all right.

I see—

—oh. Oh, crap.

#### Jinx Bubastis

I know this is going to sound like an excuse,  
but I didn't *force* him to pull the trigger.

### Panel 3 (*Half page width. 1/3rd page height*):

**Jinx Bubastis** has walked up to **Peter Cat**, who is now holding her.

#### Jinx Bubastis

I pushed a *cruel idea* into his mind, and *something gave way*.

Bearcat was a smart guy.

He had years of *fears* and *doubts* and *nobody to talk to*.

#### Peter Cat

He probably *knew* one of the *bombs* was here.

### Panel 4 (*Half page width. 1/3rd page height*):

A close view of **Peter Cat** and **Jinx Bubastis**.

#### Peter Cat

I guess no one is innocent.

### Panel 5 (*Full page width. 1/3rd page height*):

A view a bit later, in front of the landed **Black Sabbath**. **Peter Cat** and **Jinx Bubastis** watch a funeral pyre in silence, huddled together.

## Page 24

### **Panel 1** (*Half page width. 1/3rd page height*):

Nighttime. An exterior view of a nice apartment in Georgetown, Washington, DC. Though the window, a telephone can be heard ringing. It's a smartphone, lying on the kitchen table.

### **Box** (*narration, upper left*)

That evening, in Washington, DC...

### **Panel 2** (*Half page width. 1/3rd page height*):

A woman – **Image**, of the **Ready Men** – observes the telephone continuing to ring. She is unscrewing a silencer from the end of a Colt 1911 style .45 pistol. She looks down at the ground.

### **Panel 3** (*Full page width. 1/3rd page height*):

**Jake Lyon** lies dead on the floor of his kitchen. **Image** looks at him evenly, and sends a message through the **World of Ash**.

### **Image** (*Words of Power*)

Teacher.

The work is done.

### **Voice** (*Words of Power via the World of Ash*)

Then go.

We will handle the rest.

### **Panel 4** (*Half page width. 1/3rd page height*):

**Image** disappears, leaving only a whiff of ectoplasm.

### **Panel 5** (*Half page width. 1/3rd page height*):

Nighttime, in the kitchen of **Jake Lyon's** Georgetown apartment, in the dark.